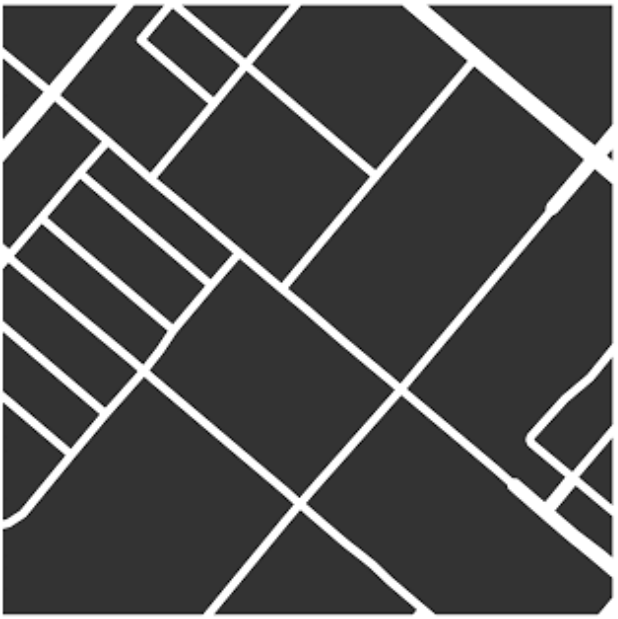
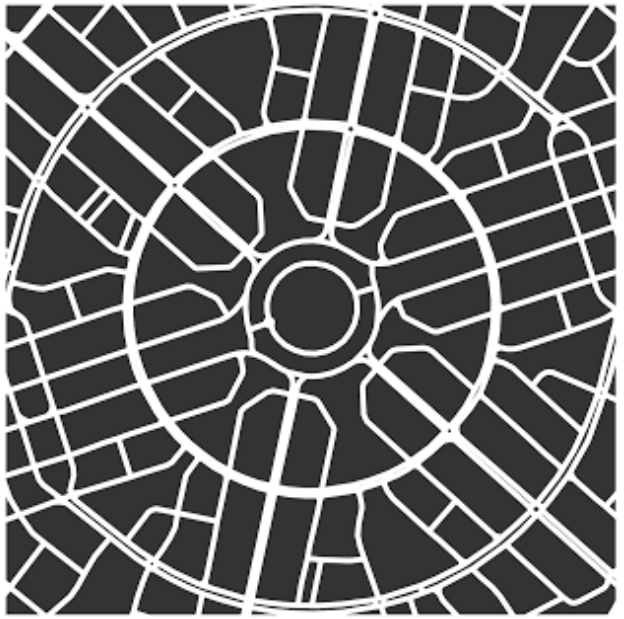




Urban Form

ARCH 305 Architecture and Town Planning

Review

Planning Approaches

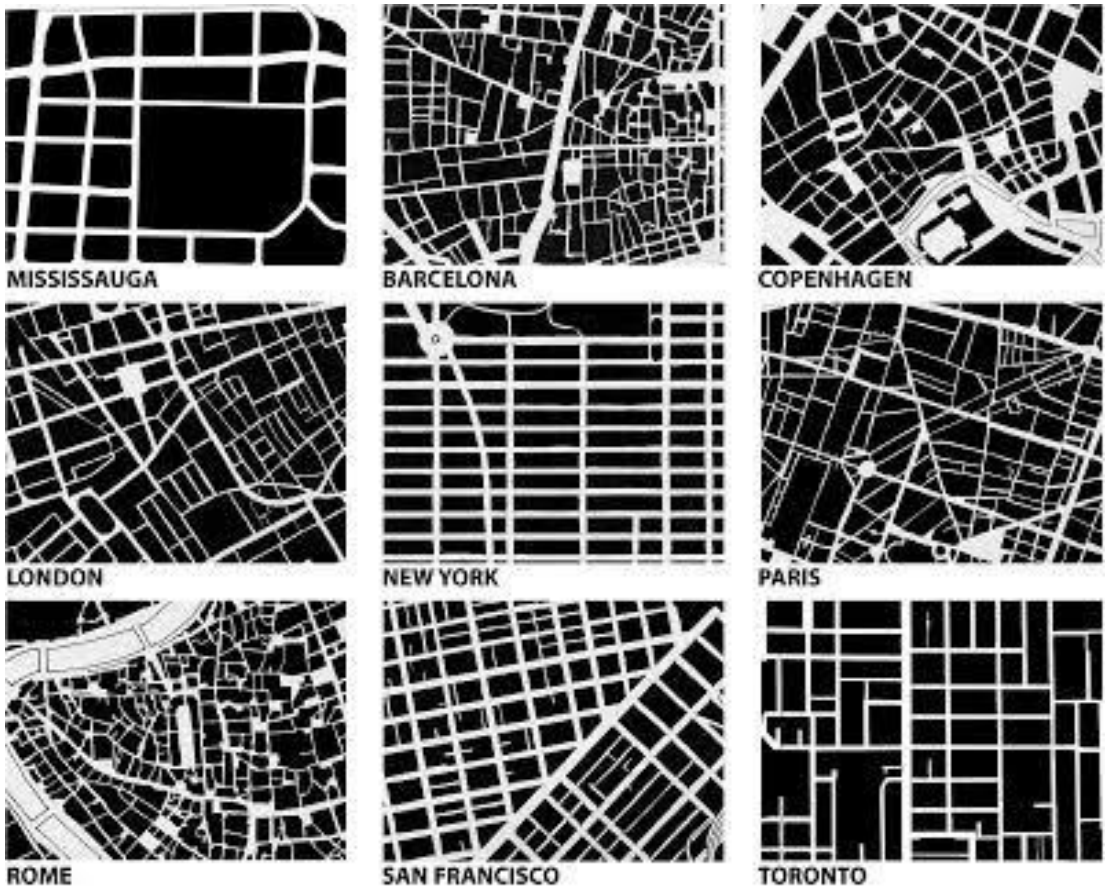
Contents

- Urban form
- Elements of Urban form
- Automobile and growth of cities
- Inner city and suburban

Urban Form(1)

Every human settlement consists of certain elements.

Interaction of these elements form a pattern - **the urban pattern**.





BARCELONA



VENICE

Urban Form(2)



- The **urban pattern** is a result of the relationships between people and their social, economic and physical environments.
- Buildings and spaces are created by people and quite often characterize them

Urban Form(3)

- Human-environment relationship is a two-way process termed as the socio-spatial dialectic.
- urban patterns are influenced by the relationship of;
  - Land ownership patterns
  - Technology
  - transportation
  - planning regulations
  - existing land use
  - street patterns
  - Communication, and
  - Socioeconomic conditions
    - Migration. Race, religion, ethnic composition

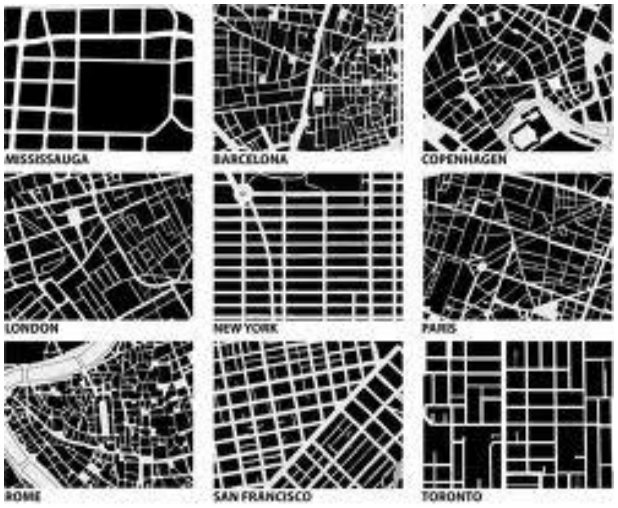
Urban Form(4)

Urban form:

- The broad overall physical geographic arrangement of land-use and transportation facilities determines the urban form.



- Urban form **encompasses the nature of the transportation networks** and **configuration of land use** such as mono-centric versus polycentric



Urban Form(5)

- The more detailed physical aspects and relationships of the urban form are usually referred to as the urban design or site design



- The urban design structure defines the urban form and the building form



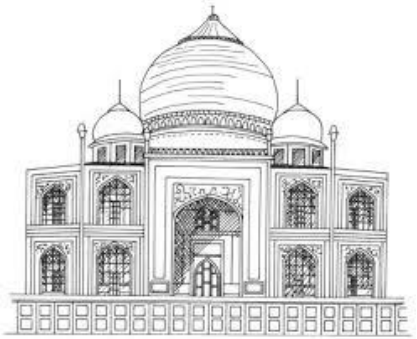
Elements of Urban Form(1)

Urban Design involves the design and coordination of all that makes up cities and towns:

Buildings:

- Buildings are the most pronounced elements of urban design - they shape and articulate space by forming the street walls of the city.
- Well designed buildings and groups of buildings work together to create a sense of place.







Elements of Urban Form(2)

Public Space

- Great public spaces are the **living room of the city** - the place where people come together to enjoy the city and each other.
- Public spaces make high quality life in the city possible
- Public spaces range from grand central plazas and squares, to small, local neighborhood parks.





Elements of Urban Form(3)

Streets

- Streets are the **connections between spaces and places**, as well as being spaces themselves.
- They are defined by their physical dimension and character as well as the size, scale, and character of the buildings that line them.
- Streets range from grand avenues to small, intimate pedestrian streets.
- The pattern of the street network is part of what defines a city and what makes each city unique.

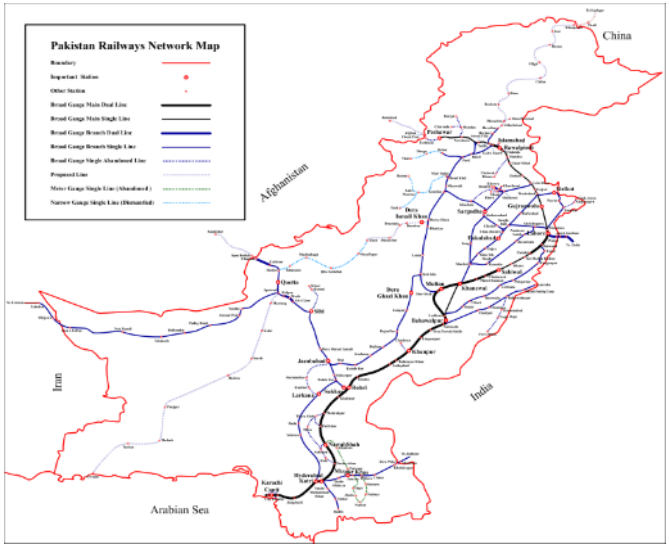




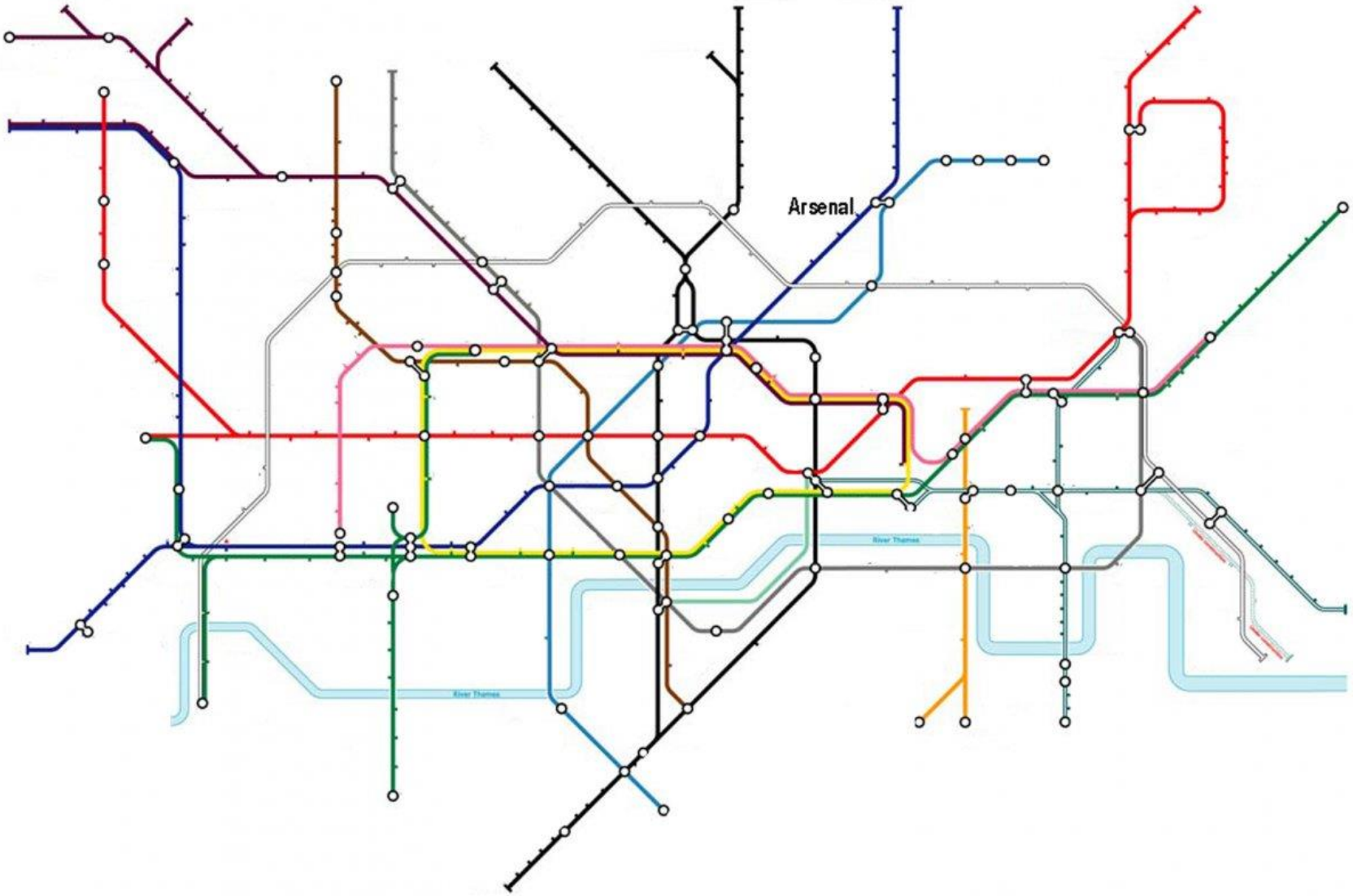
Elements of Urban Form(4)

Transport

- Transport systems connect the parts of cities and help shape them, and enable movement throughout the city.
- They include road, rail, bicycle, and pedestrian networks, and together form the total movement system of a city.
- The best cities are the ones that elevate the experience of the pedestrian while minimizing the dominance of the private automobile.







LONDON

Elements of Urban Form(5)

Landscape

- The landscape is the green part of the city that weaves throughout - in the form of urban parks, street trees, plants, flowers, and water in many forms.
- The landscape helps define the character and beauty of a city and creates soft, contrasting spaces and elements.
- Green spaces in cities range from grand parks such as Central Park in New York City and the Washington DC Mall, to small intimate pocket parks.






THANK
YOU!